Note on Dates and Transliteration

For accessibility and ease of reading the main text of this book, every effort has been made to make dates and transliterations less cumbersome. Rulers' reigns and timespans of specific years are provided in both Hijra and Common Era dates; while less specific ranges are given only in the Common Era. Furthermore, transliteration has been utilized where strictly called for: the many Arabic, Persian and Indic-language words throughout the main text and footnotes have not been transliterated; only the *ayn* and *hamza* have been differentiated. However, to be consistent with the extensive Arabic and Persian texts of inscriptions reproduced in the Appendix, all non-English words have been transliterated there: the Arabic–Persian adhering to the *International Journal of Middle East Studies* recommendations, and the Indic-language words following the guidelines in John T. Platts's *A Dictionary of Urdu, Classical Hindi and English*.